

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

1025 Lucerne Drive, Menasha, Wisconsin, 54952 | samuelkocho.sk@gmail.com |
www.linkedin.com/in/sangjunko

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
Bachelor of Science in Statistics (CGPA: 3.93/4.00)

- Mathematics Minor

Champaign, Illinois
January 2023 - May 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staffmark Group (on assignment at Kimberly-Clark)
Statistician

Neenah, Wisconsin
June 2025 - Present

- Design and run DOE experiments and curate home-use-test and lab data to build regression models that predict consumer perception from bench measurements, reducing reliance on expensive, multi-month consumer home-use testing
- Built and deployed leakageReport, a Flask-based statistical reporting module that replaced an outdated legacy system for mannequin leakage studies—continually improving reporting workflows for 50+ users; now the team standard
- Built and deployed 5 additional Python modules on an internal analytics platform, including a usage-tracking dashboard and predictive-modeling UIs, managing Git-based version control for the codebase and serving as the team's liaison to address structural data needs
- Lead or support 10+ concurrent Test Method Validation (TMV) and Gauge R&R studies (basis weight, tensile, caliper, tear strength, attribute inspection) across product lines, translating bias/precision results into pass/fail recommendations and spec-limit proposals

STAT107 Data Science Discovery
Undergraduate Course Assistant

Champaign, Illinois
August 2023 - May 2025

- Assisted over 300 students with fundamental data science concepts through interactive labs
- Managed Git for learning platform modifications, benefiting 1000+ students; create, edit, and proofread course materials

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences
AI/ML Intern Team Leader

Champaign, Illinois
January 2024 - December 2024

- Lead a team of 5 interns and collaborated closely with 3 coordinators in weekly meetings
- Built ML models with 100,000+ data points using Python and advanced techniques like XGBoost and BERT

PROJECTS / AWARDS

Graduation Prediction Model

- Increased AUC score from 0.65 to 0.82 by reducing noise in the dataset through feature engineering and outlier removal across 50,000+ student records
- Built a Streamlit interface with 12 key predictors for real-time predictions for university administrators

3rd Place, 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge

- Analyzed the socioeconomic and mental health impacts of COVID-19 in Mexico, identifying that 42% of females and 40% of young adults faced job loss
- Proposed data-driven interventions to support vulnerable groups through geospatial and statistical analysis

Paraphrase Detection

- Achieved 90%+ accuracy in paraphrase detection using BERT, RoBERTa, and SBERT models on the MRPC dataset
- Developed a Gradio interface for real-time detection for easier evaluation of textual similarities

SKILLS

Languages: English (Fluent), Spanish (Native), Korean (Native), French (Basic), Chinese (Basic)
Computer: Python (Advanced): Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, NLTK, Matplotlib
R (Intermediate): Tidyverse, ggplot2, dplyr, caret
Flask (Intermediate), Git (Intermediate), SAS (Intermediate), SQL (Basic)
Tableau (Basic), Office (Advanced)
Certificates: Data Science Certificate, Coursera Business Analytics Certificate

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Volunteer, Appleton Public Library
Consultant in Illinois Business Consulting

August 2025 - Present
September 2024 - December 2024